Acceptable Use and Generative AI Policy

Example Manufacturing GmbH. Document IT-04, version 2.0, owners: Chief Information Officer and Data Protection Officer, effective 1 January 2026.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy describes how company IT resources, including generative AI tools, may be used. It applies to all employees and contractors who use company devices, accounts or data.

2. General Acceptable Use

Company IT resources are provided for business purposes. Limited personal use is allowed if it does not interfere with work, security or other employees. Illegal content, cryptocurrency mining and the installation of unlicensed software are prohibited. Software is installed only through the company software center.

3. Email and Collaboration

Confidential documents are shared with external parties only through the company file sharing service, using links that expire after at most 30 days. Automatic forwarding of company email to private email accounts is prohibited.

4. Approved Generative AI Tools

Only the generative AI tools on the approved AI tools list on the intranet may be used with company information. At the moment the list contains the enterprise chat assistant, which is covered by a data processing agreement, and the code assistant for software developers.

Public, free AI tools may only be used with information that is already public.

5. Data Classification and AI Tools

Company information is classified as Public, Internal, Confidential or Strictly Confidential. Internal information may be entered only into approved AI tools. Confidential information may be entered only into approved AI tools that process data in the EU.

Strictly Confidential information, such as unreleased product designs, merger and acquisition plans or salary data, must never be entered into any generative AI tool. Personal data of customers, applicants or employees must never be entered into a generative AI tool unless a data protection impact assessment (DPIA) has approved that specific use case.

6. Human Review and Labelling

AI output must be reviewed by a person before it is used externally or as the basis for a decision. Images and texts generated with AI that are published externally must be labelled as AI-generated. Source code produced with an AI assistant goes through the normal code review and the open source license scan.

7. New AI Use Cases

Every new AI use case must be registered with the AI Governance Board before development starts. The board classifies the use case under the EU AI Act. High-risk use cases, for example in

recruiting or in the evaluation of employee performance, need the approval of the board and a DPIA.

Prohibited practices, such as recognising the emotions of employees, will not be approved. The board meets monthly and decides on complete requests within 20 working days.

8. Monitoring

The company may monitor the use of IT systems for security purposes in line with the agreement with the works council. IT logs are not used to monitor the performance of individual employees.

9. Violations

Violations of this policy may lead to the withdrawal of access rights and to disciplinary action.